



FCL vs LCL Shipping Comparison

Updated April 2026 | Container Shipping to Kenya

FCL VS LCL: QUICK COMPARISON

FCL (Full Container Load)

You rent an entire container exclusively for your cargo.

- **Best for:** 15+ CBM of cargo
- **Cost:** Fixed per container
- **Transit:** Faster (no consolidation)
- **Security:** Sealed from origin

LCL (Less than Container Load)

Your cargo shares a container with other shippers.

- **Best for:** Under 15 CBM
- **Cost:** Pay per CBM used
- **Transit:** Slower (3-7 days extra)
- **Security:** More handling

CONTAINER TYPES & CAPACITIES

Container	Dimensions	Capacity	Weight Limit
20ft Standard	5.9m × 2.35m × 2.39m	33 CBM	28 tons
40ft Standard	12.03m × 2.35m × 2.39m	67 CBM	26 tons
40ft High Cube	12.03m × 2.35m × 2.69m	76 CBM	26 tons
20ft Reefer	5.44m × 2.26m × 2.27m	28 CBM	27 tons

CBM Tip: 1 CBM ≈ 1 standard pallet. A 20ft container holds ~10-12 pallets.

FCL SHIPPING COSTS TO KENYA

Origin	20ft Container	40ft Container	Transit Time
Shanghai, China	USD 1,500 - 3,500	USD 2,500 - 5,500	18-25 days
Dubai, UAE	USD 800 - 1,800	USD 1,200 - 2,500	10-14 days
Singapore	USD 1,000 - 2,000	USD 1,500 - 3,000	12-16 days
Rotterdam, Netherlands	USD 2,000 - 4,000	USD 3,500 - 6,000	21-28 days

LCL SHIPPING COSTS TO KENYA

Origin	Rate per CBM	Minimum Charge	Transit Time
Shanghai, China	USD 30 - 80	2-3 CBM	22-32 days
Dubai, UAE	USD 20 - 50	2 CBM	14-20 days
Singapore	USD 25 - 60	2 CBM	16-22 days
Europe	USD 40 - 90	3 CBM	25-35 days

Note: LCL adds 3-7 days to transit time due to consolidation/deconsolidation.

When to Choose FCL vs LCL	
Situation	Recommended
Cargo exceeds 15-20 CBM	FCL
Cargo under 15 CBM	LCL
High-value or fragile goods	FCL
Time-sensitive shipments	FCL
Testing new market	LCL
Limited budget upfront	LCL

Total Cost Calculator

FCL Total =
Ocean Freight + Origin Charges + Mombasa Port Fees + Brokerage + Transport

LCL Total =
(CBM × Freight Rate) + Consolidation Fee + Deconsolidation + Clearance + Transport

Mombasa Port Charges	
Charge Type	Amount (USD)
Container Handling (per TEU)	USD 150 - 500
Port Dues	USD 50 - 150
CFS Handling (LCL)	USD 50 - 150
Customs Brokerage	USD 100 - 300

1. Calculate your cargo volume in CBM

2. Is volume > 15-20 CBM?

→ YES: Get FCL quotes

→ NO: Compare FCL vs LCL costs

3. Is cargo high-value or time-sensitive?

→ YES: Choose FCL regardless of volume

4. Get quotes for both and compare total landed costs

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Get instant shipping quotes at kenyatradox.africa/ocean-freight.html

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